

BUG BOUNTY FIELD GUIDE

Netlas Dorking

Lucene Query Syntax, Real-World Dorks &
Automation for Bug Bounty Hunters and
Penetration Testers

- Domain-Centric Discovery
- 2025 Edition

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1. Introduction to Netlas

Netlas is a relatively new (founded 2022) internet asset search engine built on Apache Lucene (Elasticsearch). Unlike legacy scanners, Netlas indexes **both IP addresses and domain names** simultaneously — maintaining a separate DNS index alongside its service scan data. This dual approach makes Netlas exceptionally powerful for **domain-centric reconnaissance** and virtual host discovery. 🌐

For bug bounty hunters, Netlas offers several unique advantages: it finds significantly more unique web resources than competitors due to virtual host handling (~344 million HTTP services vs ~145 million on Shodan), provides built-in DNS and WHOIS lookup tools, supports regex body searches, and offers CVE correlation out of the box. 🎯

Why Netlas Matters for Bug Bounty

Domain + IP Indexing: Discovers virtual hosts and aliases others miss. **2x+ Web Coverage:** ~344M HTTP services indexed. **Lucene Power:** Regex, fuzzy search, wildcards, ranges built-in. **Built-in DNS/WHOIS:** No need for external dig/whois tools. **CVE Native:** Direct vulnerability correlation with exploit flags. **Private Scanner:** On-demand subnet scanning in the familiar UI.

How Netlas Works

Netlas operates four core search tools:

- **Responses Search** — HTTP/HTTPS service data with full body, headers, title, favicon
- **DNS Search** — A, MX, TXT, NS, CNAME records and DNS content analysis
- **IP Search** — Host-level data with ports, banners, geolocation, ASN
- **Certificates Search** — Full SSL/TLS certificate chains with Subject, Issuer, SANs
- **WHOIS Search** — Domain registration data, contacts, registrars

Netlas Search Tools Workflow

1. Responses Search for web app recon (titles, bodies, headers). **2. DNS Search** for subdomain enumeration and record analysis. **3. IP Search** for network mapping and port discovery. **4. Certificates Search** for SSL-based asset correlation. **5. WHOIS Search** for org contact intelligence and domain history.

Account Tiers

Table 1 Netlas Pricing Plans

Plan	Cost	API Requests/Month	API Rate Limit
Community	Free	Limited	1 req/sec
Freelancer	\$49/mo	30,000	1 req/sec
Business	\$249/mo	Unlimited	2 req/sec
Corporate	\$830/mo	Unlimited	5 req/sec
Enterprise	Custom	Unlimited	Higher

Netlas Access Notes

Netlas offers **API and CLI access even on the free Community tier** — a major advantage over competitors. The web interface provides query examples for each tool. Regex search, vulnerability search, and tag search require paid plans. Sign up at netlas.io.

2. Netlas Query Language

Netlas is built on Apache Lucene — the same engine powering Elasticsearch and Kibana. This means standard Lucene query syntax applies: field:value pairs, boolean logic, ranges, wildcards, fuzzy matching, and regular expressions. Mastering this syntax unlocks Netlas's full potential. 

2.1 Basic Syntax & Fields

SYNTAX

Table 2 Basic Query Syntax

Pattern	Description	Example
<code>field:value</code>	Exact match in field	<code>host:google.com</code>
<code>field:"value"</code>	Phrase match (multi-word)	<code>http.title:"Login Page"</code>
<code>field:*</code>	Field exists (any value)	<code>http.title:*</code>
<code>field.subfield</code>	Nested field (dot notation)	<code>geo.country:"United States"</code>
<code>keyword</code>	Search default fields	<code>netlas</code> (no field)

Important: No Spaces Around Colons

In Lucene syntax, there must be **no spaces** between the field name, colon, and value. Spaces act as condition separators. Wrong: `host : google.com` . Correct: `host:google.com` .

2.2 Logical & Range Operators

LOGIC

Table 3 Logical & Range Operators

Operator	Description	Example
AND / &&	Both conditions must match	<code>port:443 AND protocol:https</code>
OR /	Either condition matches	<code>port:80 OR port:443</code>
NOT / !	Exclude condition	<code>protocol:ssh NOT port:22</code>
()	Grouping for precedence	<code>(port:8080 OR port:8088) AND protocol:http</code>
[a TO b]	Inclusive range	<code>ip:[173.194.222.0 TO 173.194.222.255]</code>
{a TO b}	Exclusive range	<code>port:{80 TO 443}</code>
$\geq$ $\leq$	One-sided comparison	<code>port:$\leq$1000</code>

2.3 Wildcards, Fuzziness & Regex

ADVANCED

Table 4 Advanced Search Operators

Operator	Description	Example
*	Multi-character wildcard	<code>domain:*example.com</code>
?	Single-character wildcard	<code>host:test?.example.com</code>
~	Fuzzy search (edit distance)	<code>title:Josph~</code> (catches Joseph)

<code>~1 / ~2</code>	Fuzzy with specific distance	<code>title:admin~1</code>
<code>/regex/</code>	Regular expression	<code>http.body:/password.*123/</code>
<code>CIDR</code>	IP subnet search	<code>host:192.168.0.0/16</code>
<code>now-Xd</code>	Relative date range	<code>@timestamp:[now-7d TO now]</code>

Regex Body Search Power

Netlas supports **regular expressions in response body searches** — a feature many competitors lack. This lets you hunt for patterns like API keys, JWT tokens, or specific error messages with surgical precision. Example: `http.body:/AKIA[0-9A-Z]{16}/` finds AWS access keys in HTML.

3. Core Search Filters

3.1 Host & Network Filters

NETWORK

Table 5 Host & Network Fields

Filter	Description	Example
<code>ip</code>	IPv4/IPv6 address	<code>ip:8.8.8.8</code>
<code>host</code>	Hostname or IP with port	<code>host:example.com</code>
<code>domain</code>	Base domain	<code>domain:example.com</code>
<code>uri</code>	Full URI including path	<code>uri:*example.com/admin*</code>
<code>port</code>	Port number	<code>port:9200</code>
<code>protocol</code>	Protocol (http, https, ssh, etc.)	<code>protocol:https</code>
<code>geo.country</code>	Country name	<code>geo.country:"United States"</code>
<code>geo.city</code>	City name	<code>geo.city:London</code>
<code>asn</code>	Autonomous System Number	<code>asn:15169</code>

path

URL path

path:/admin

3.2 HTTP & Content Filters

WEB CONTENT

Table 6 HTTP & Content Fields

Filter	Description		Example
http.title	HTML page title		http.title:"Login"
http.body	Response content	body	http.body:admin
http.headers.server	Server header		http.headers.server:nginx
http.headers.www_authenticate	Auth header		http.headers.www_authenticate:Basic
http.status	HTTP status code		http.status:200
http.meta	Meta tag content		http.meta:generator
http.favicon	Favicon hash (mmh3)		http.favicon:-335242539
banner	Service banner text		banner:"OpenSSH"

3.3 Certificate & Tag Filters

CERT & TAGS

Table 7 Certificate & Tag Fields

Filter	Description		Example
certificate.subject.CN	Cert Name	Common	certificate.subject.CN:"*.example.com"
certificate.subject.organization	Org in cert subject		certificate.subject.organization:"Google LLC"

<code>certificate.issuer.organization</code>	Cert issuer org	<code>certificate.issuer.organization:"Dig iCert"</code>
<code>certificate.issuer.email_address</code>	Issuer contact email	<code>certificate.issuer.email_address:*</code>
<code>certificate.fingerprint_sha256</code>	SHA256 fingerprint	<code>certificate.fingerprint_sha256:abc123...</code>
<code>tag.name</code>	Product tag name	<code>tag.name:"adobe_coldfusion"</code>
<code>tag.category</code>	Tag category	<code>tag.category:"cms"</code>

3.4 CVE & Vulnerability Filters

VULNERABILITIES

Table 8 CVE Fields

Filter	Description	Example
<code>cve</code>	Any CVE present	<code>cve:*</code>
<code>cve.name</code>	Specific CVE ID	<code>cve.name:CVE-2021-44228</code>
<code>cve.description</code>	CVE description text	<code>cve.description:log4j</code>
<code>cve.has_exploit</code>	Has public exploit	<code>cve.has_exploit:true</code>
<code>cve.cvss_score</code>	CVSS score range	<code>cve.cvss_score:[9.0 TO 10.0]</code>

Tag-Based Search

Netlas auto-tags services with product names. Tags cover Blogs (wordpress, medium), CDN (cloudflare, google_cloud), CMS (joomla, drupal), Ecommerce (magento, opencart), and many more. Click the tag icon in the search bar to browse all available tags. `tag.name` requires Business+ plan.

4. Bug Bounty Dorks by Category

These Netlas queries are crafted for real-world bug bounty hunting. Every dork targets a specific exposure type with copy-paste precision. 🎯

4.1 Admin Panels & Consoles

HIGH-IMPACT

ADMIN Jenkins Dashboard

Unprotected Jenkins instances expose build pipelines, secrets, and script console RCE.

```
http.title:"Dashboard [Jenkins]" AND http.headers.server:*
```

ADMIN Apache Tomcat Manager

Tomcat manager allows WAR deployment for remote code execution.

```
http.title:"Apache Tomcat" AND http.body:manager
```

ADMIN phpMyAdmin

phpMyAdmin interfaces with weak credentials = full database compromise.

```
http.title:"phpMyAdmin" AND http.body:pma_username
```

ADMIN Grafana Login

Grafana exposes metrics, logs, and potentially admin panels.

```
http.title:"Grafana" AND tag.name:grafana
```

ADMIN **Kubernetes Dashboard**

Exposed K8s dashboards allow pod execution and cluster takeover.

```
http.title:"Kubernetes Dashboard" AND http.body:Kubernetes
```

ADMIN **Docker Registry**

Unauthenticated registries leak container images and source artifacts.

```
http.title:"Docker Registry" AND port:5000
```

ADMIN **Kibana Elasticsearch**

Kibana exposes indexed logs and allows Elasticsearch query execution.

```
http.title:"Kibana" AND port:5601
```

ADMIN **Cisco ASDM / VPN**

Cisco security devices with known CVEs and default configurations.

```
http.title:"Cisco ASDM" AND certificate.subject.CN:*cisco*
```

4.2 Databases & Data Leaks

SENSITIVE DATA

DATABASE **Open Elasticsearch**

Unauthenticated Elasticsearch exposes all indexed data — P1 severity.

```
port:9200 AND http.body:cluster_name AND http.body:indices
```

DATABASE Exposed MongoDB

MongoDB without auth exposes entire databases on default port 27017.

```
port:27017 AND banner:MongoDB
```

DATABASE Redis Unprotected

Redis without AUTH exposes cached data and may allow config rewrite RCE.

```
port:6379 AND banner:redis_version
```

LEAKED AWS S3 Buckets

Misconfigured S3 with public ListBucketResult XML exposed.

```
http.body:ListBucketResult AND http.body:s3.amazonaws.com
```

LEAKED Git Config Exposure

.git/config files leak repository URLs, paths, and sometimes credentials.

```
http.body:"[core]" AND http.body:repositoryformatversion
```

LEAKED Open Directory Listings

Directory indexes expose backups, configs, and sensitive files.

```
http.title:"Index of /" AND http.body:"Parent Directory"
```

4.3 Cloud & DevOps Exposure

CLOUD INFRA

CLOUD **Swagger / OpenAPI Docs**

Exposed Swagger UI reveals API endpoints, schemas, and test tokens.

```
http.title:"Swagger UI" AND http.body:swagger-ui
```

CLOUD **GraphQL Playground**

GraphQL introspection allows full schema discovery and data extraction.

```
http.title:"GraphQL Playground" AND http.body:graphql
```

CLOUD **MinIO Storage Console**

MinIO interfaces may expose buckets without authentication.

```
http.title:"MinIO Browser" AND http.body:MinIO
```

DEVOPS **Prometheus Metrics**

Exposed /metrics endpoints leak system metrics and sometimes paths.

```
http.body:process_resident_memory_bytes OR http.body:http_requests_total
```

DEVOPS **Docker-Compose / .env Leaks**

Config files in web roots leak credentials, API keys, and secrets.

```
http.body:DB_PASSWORD AND http.body:APP_KEY
```

CLOUD **Firebase / App Configs**

Exposed mobile app configs and cloud function endpoints.

```
http.body:firebaseio.com OR http.body:appspot.com
```

4.4 API Keys & Secrets

SECRETS

SECRET AWS Access Keys

AWS access key IDs (AKIA/ASIA prefix) exposed in source code.

```
http.body:/AKIA[0-9A-Z]{16}/
```

SECRET Google API Keys

Google Maps, Firebase, and Cloud API keys in JavaScript.

```
http.body:/AIza[0-9A-Za-z_-]{35}/
```

SECRET Stripe Keys

Stripe publishable and secret keys leaked in frontend or configs.

```
http.body:pk_live_ OR http.body:sk_live_
```

SECRET Slack / Discord Webhooks

Webhook URLs in source code allowing unauthorized message injection.

```
http.body:hooks.slack.com OR http.body:discord.com/api/webhooks
```

SECRET JWT / Bearer Tokens

Hardcoded JWT secrets or bearer tokens in frontend JS.

```
http.body:/Bearer eyJ[0-9A-Za-z_-]*/
```

SECRET Private Keys in HTML

RSA/EC private keys accidentally exposed in HTTP responses.

```
http.body:"BEGIN RSA PRIVATE KEY" OR http.body:"BEGIN OPENSSH PRIVATE KEY"
```

4.5 Vulnerable Services & CVEs

CVE HUNTING

CVE Log4j / Log4Shell

Java apps with Log4j vulnerable to JNDI injection RCE.

```
cve.name:CVE-2021-44228 AND http.body:log4j
```

CVE F5 BIG-IP (CVE-2022-1388)

BIG-IP iControl REST auth bypass — critical unauthenticated RCE.

```
http.title:"BIG-IP" AND tag.name:f5_bigip
```

CVE Apache Struts (CVE-2017-5638)

Apache Struts with OGNL expression injection on legacy systems.

```
tag.name:apache_struts AND http.status:200
```

CVE Exploitable CVEs with Public Exploits

Find vulnerable services that have known public exploits ready to use.

```
cve.has_exploit:true AND cve.cvss_score:[9.0 TO 10.0]
```

CVE Vulnerable WebLogic Servers

Oracle WebLogic with known CVEs and remote code execution history.

```
cve.description:weblogic AND cve.has_exploit:true
```

CVE SQL Injection Error Pages

Pages showing MySQL/PostgreSQL error messages — potential SQLi vectors.

```
http.body:mysql_fetch_array AND http.body:warning
```

5. Targeting Specific Organizations

Netlas's domain-centric approach makes it exceptional for organization-targeted reconnaissance. The dual IP+domain index reveals virtual hosts and aliases that pure IP scanners miss. 🌐

Organization Enumeration Strategy

STEP-BY-STEP TARGETING

```
# Step 1: Base domain wildcard search
domain:*.example.com

# Step 2: Find all subdomains via DNS
dns.name:*.example.com

# Step 3: Certificate-based discovery
certificate.subject.CN:*.example.com

# Step 4: Combine domain + specific service
domain:*.example.com AND (http.title:admin OR http.title:login)

# Step 5: Exclude cloud providers to find bare metal
domain:*.example.com NOT domain:*.amazonaws.com NOT domain:*.cloudflare.com

# Step 6: Find non-standard ports
domain:*.example.com AND NOT port:(80 OR 443 OR 8080 OR 8443)

# Step 7: HTTPS on unusual ports (often dev/staging)
domain:*.example.com AND protocol:https AND NOT port:443
```

DNS-Based Subdomain Enumeration

DNS Search Tool Power

Netlas's separate **DNS Search** tool indexes A, MX, TXT, NS, and CNAME records. Search by DNS content to find SPF records pointing to third-party services (revealing email infrastructure), MX records (email providers), or TXT records with verification tokens.

DNS RECON QUERIES

```
# Find all subdomains via DNS A records
dns.name:*.example.com

# Discover email infrastructure via MX records
dns.mx:*.example.com

# SPF records revealing third-party services
dns.txt:mailgun AND domain:*.example.com

# Find domains with DMARC records (email security posture)
dns.txt:"v=DMARC1" AND domain:*.example.com

# CNAME-based discovery (often reveals CDNs and PaaS)
dns.cname:*.herokudns.com AND domain:*.example.com
```

Certificate SAN Enumeration

CERTIFICATE RECON

```
# Find all SANs for a target domain
certificate.subject.CN:*.example.com

# Find related domains sharing the same issuer
certificate.issuer.organization:"DigiCert" AND certificate.subject.CN:*.example*

# Expired certificates (may indicate abandoned infrastructure)
certificate.subject.CN:*.example.com AND NOT certificate.is_valid:true

# Wildcard certificate enumeration
certificate.subject.CN:"*.example.com"
```

WHOIS Contact Intelligence

WHOIS RECON


```
# Find all domains registered by the same org
whois.organization:"Example Company"

# Find domains by registrant email (correlates acquisitions)
whois.email:*@example.com

# Discover related domains via registrar patterns
whois.registrar:"GoDaddy" AND whois.organization:"Example"
```

Favicon Hash Matching

FAVICON HASH WORKFLOW

```
# 1. Get favicon from target
curl -s https://target.com/favicon.ico | python3 -c "
import sys, mmh3, base64
img = sys.stdin.buffer.read()
print(mmh3.hash(base64.encodebytes(img)))
"

# 2. Search Netlas by hash
http.favicon:-335242539

# 3. Combine with domain for precision
http.favicon:-335242539 AND domain:*.target.com

# 4. Find global shadow deployments
http.favicon:-335242539 AND NOT domain:*.target.com
```

6. Netlas API & Automation

Netlas provides a Python library, CLI tool, and REST API — all accessible even on the free tier. This makes automation easy and cost-effective for bug bounty hunters. 🤖

Python SDK Setup

INSTALLATION & AUTH

```
# Install Netlas Python library
pip install netlas

# Get API key from https://app.netlas.io/profile/
# Set as environment variable or pass directly
export NETLAS_API_KEY=your_api_key
```

Python API Examples

PYTHON: TARGETED ENUMERATION

```
import netlas

apikey = "YOUR_API_KEY"

# Create connection
netlas_connection = netlas.Netlas(api_key=apikey)

# Search responses for target admin panels
query = 'domain:*.example.com AND (http.title:"admin" OR http.title:"login")'
resp = netlas_connection.query(query=query)

for item in resp['items']:
    data = item['data']
    print(f"{data.get('ip', 'N/A')} | {data.get('uri', 'N/A')} | {data.get('http', {})}")
```

PYTHON: CERTIFICATE SUBDOMAIN DISCOVERY

```
import netlas

apikey = "YOUR_API_KEY"
netlas_connection = netlas.Netlas(api_key=apikey)

# Use certificates search tool
query = 'certificate.subject.CN:*.example.com'
resp = netlas_connection.query(query=query, datatype='certificates')

domains = set()
for item in resp['items']:
    cert = item['data'].get('certificate', {})
    subject = cert.get('subject', {})
    cn = subject.get('CN', '')
    if cn:
        domains.add(cn)
    # Also extract SANs
    for san in cert.get('subject_alt_names', []):
        domains.add(san)

for d in sorted(domains):
    print(d)
```

Netlas CLI

CLI COMMANDS

```
# Install CLI
pip install netlas

# Configure API key
netlas save_key YOUR_API_KEY

# Search responses
netlas search 'domain:*.example.com AND http.title:"Login"' -f json

# Search certificates
netlas search 'certificate.subject.CN:*.example.com' -f json

# Search DNS records
netlas search 'dns.name:*.example.com' -f json

# Search with specific fields output
netlas search 'port:9200 AND http.body:cluster_name' -f json | jq '.items[].data.uri'

# Download results to file
netlas search 'cve.has_exploit:true' -f json > exploits.json
```

cURL API One-Liners

CURL WORKFLOWS

```
# Basic responses search
curl -X GET 'https://app.netlas.io/api/responses/?q=domain%3Aexample.com&source_type=include&start=0&fields=*' \
  -H 'accept: application/json' \
  -H 'X-API-Key: YOUR_API_KEY' | jq .

# Extract domains from results
curl -s -X GET 'https://app.netlas.io/api/responses/?q=domain%3A*.example.com&fields=domain,ip,port,http.title' \
  -H 'X-API-Key: YOUR_API_KEY' | jq -r '.items[].data | "\(.domain) | \(.ip):\(.port) | \(.http.title)"'

# Certificate search for SAN enumeration
curl -s -X GET 'https://app.netlas.io/api/certificates/?q=certificate.subject.CN%3A*.example.com' \
  -H 'X-API-Key: YOUR_API_KEY' | jq -r '.items[].data.certificate.subject.CN'
```

7. Netlas vs Shodan vs Censys

Each search engine has unique strengths. Understanding these differences helps you choose the right tool for each reconnaissance phase. 

Table 9 Platform Comparison

Dimension	Netlas	Shodan	Censys
Founded	2022	2009	2015
Query Language	Lucene (Elasticsearch)	Simple filters	CenQL (structured)
Domain Indexing	Native + virtual hosts	Limited	Via certificates
HTTP Services	~344 million	~145 million	~51 million IPs
Regex Search	Full regex in body	Limited	Limited
Built-in DNS/WHOIS	Yes	No	Basic WHOIS
CVE Correlation	Native + exploit flag	Membership only	Via integrations
Private Scanner	Yes (Freelancer+)	No	ASM only
Free API	Yes (limited)	100 credits/mo	250 queries/mo
Cheapest Paid	\$49/mo (30K requests)	\$49/mo	\$69/mo (500 req)

When to Use Which

Table 10 Tool Selection Guide

Task	Best Tool	Why
Domain + virtual host discovery	Netlas	Native domain indexing, most web resources
Regex pattern in response body	Netlas	Full Lucene regex support
Built-in DNS/WHOIS lookup	Netlas	Integrated tools, no external utilities
CVE with exploit flag hunting	Netlas	Native cve.has_exploit filter
IoT / webcam discovery	Shodan	Largest IoT device database
Screenshots of web UIs	Shodan	Built-in screenshot capture
Certificate SAN enumeration	Censys	Deepest certificate chain indexing
SSL org field company mapping	Censys	O= field search is unmatched

High-accuracy service data	Censys	92% accuracy, fewer stale results
Quick budget recon	Netlas	Free API + most requests per dollar

Pro Strategy: The Trifecta

For maximum coverage, run the same target query on **all three** platforms. Netlas finds virtual hosts and domains others miss. Shodan surfaces IoT and screenshots. Censys provides the deepest certificate and accuracy validation. Cross-reference results for the most complete attack surface map.

8. Integration & Workflow

Netlas integrates seamlessly into modern bug bounty reconnaissance pipelines. Here are proven workflows. [🔗](#)

Netlas + Subfinder + httpx Pipeline

FULL RECON CHAIN

```
# Phase 1: Netlas domain discovery
curl -s -X GET 'https://app.netlas.io/api/responses/?q=domain%3A*.target.com&fields=domain' \
  -H 'X-API-Key: KEY' | jq -r '.items[].data.domain' | sort -u | tee netlas_domains.txt

# Phase 2: Expand with Subfinder
subfinder -d target.com -all -silent | anew netlas_domains.txt

# Phase 3: Resolve and validate
cat netlas_domains.txt | dnsx -a -silent | tee resolved.txt

# Phase 4: Live HTTP probing with metadata
cat netlas_domains.txt | httpx -title -status-code -tech-detect -o live_http.txt

# Phase 5: Netlas deep scan on interesting hosts
for domain in $(cat netlas_domains.txt | head -50); do
    curl -s "https://app.netlas.io/api/responses/?q=domain:${domain}&fields=port,http.title,banner" \
      -H 'X-API-Key: KEY' >> netlas_deep.jsonl
done
```

Netlas + Nuclei CVE Validation

CVE HUNT CHAIN

```
# Step 1: Netlas query for exploitable CVEs
curl -s -X GET 'https://app.netlas.io/api/responses/?q=cve.has_exploit%3Atrue%20AND%20domain%3A*.target.com&fields=ip,port,uri,http.title' \
-H 'X-API-Key: KEY' | jq -r '.items[].data | "\(.uri)"' | sort -u | tee cve_targets.txt

# Step 2: Validate live hosts
cat cve_targets.txt | httpprobe | tee live_cve.txt

# Step 3: Run Nuclei on confirmed targets
cat live_cve.txt | nuclei -t cves/ -severity critical,high -o nuclei_results.txt
```

Continuous Monitoring

MONITOR SCRIPT

```
#!/usr/bin/env python3
# netlas_monitor.py – Daily asset change detection

import netlas, json, datetime, os

apikey = "YOUR_API_KEY"
TARGET = "*.target.com"
STATE_FILE = "netlas_state.json"

conn = netlas.Netlas(api_key=apikey)

# Load known state
try:
    with open(STATE_FILE) as f:
        known = set(json.load(f))
except:
    known = set()

# Query current assets
query = f'domain:{TARGET}'
resp = conn.query(query=query, fields='ip,port,domain')

current = set()
for item in resp.get('items', []):
    d = item.get('data', {})
    current.add(f"{d.get('domain')}:{d.get('ip')}:{d.get('port')}")

# Detect new assets
new = current - known
if new:
    print(f"[{datetime.datetime.now()}] NEW ASSETS: {len(new)}")
    for asset in new:
        print(f"  - {asset}")
    # Notify or trigger further scans here

# Save updated state
with open(STATE_FILE, 'w') as f:
    json.dump(list(current), f)
```

9. Best Practices & Legal

Validation Checklist

Table 11 Before Reporting

Step	Action	Why
------	--------	-----

1	Confirm ownership via domain, cert subject, or WHOIS org	Shared hosting/CDNs create false positives
2	Verify exposure is in program scope	Out-of-scope reports waste triager time
3	Check if already reported	Duplicates don't earn rewards
4	Validate exploitability with manual testing	Confirmed = higher severity/payout
5	Document exact Netlas query + tool used	Shows reproducible methodology
6	Include timestamp and result screenshot	Proves finding is current

Report Template

Netlas Finding Report Template

Title: [P1] Unauthenticated Jenkins Instance at jenkins.target.com

Description: During passive reconnaissance using Netlas, I discovered an exposed Jenkins CI/CD instance belonging to [Target].

Netlas Query: `http.title:"Dashboard [Jenkins]" AND domain:*.target.com`

Asset: jenkins.target.com (IP 203.0.113.42) — confirmed live on [Date]

Impact: Unauthenticated Jenkins allows viewing build logs (potential secret exposure), running arbitrary builds, and potentially accessing the Script Console for remote code execution.

Remediation: Enable Jenkins security realm authentication. Restrict to VPN/internal network. Disable anonymous access. Review build logs for exposed secrets.

Legal & Ethical Reminders

Do not exploit without written permission. Netlas is passive, but accessing discovered systems without authorization violates CFAA, Computer Misuse Act, and similar laws. **Only report to programs where you have explicit scope. Never modify data, upload files, or execute commands on target systems. Follow responsible disclosure timelines.**

Recommended Resources

- **Netlas Search** — netlas.io (Official platform)
- **Netlas Docs** — docs.netlas.io (Query language & API reference)
- **Netlas Cookbook** — netlas.io/resources/cookbook (Query examples)

- **Netlas Python Library** — `pip install netlas`
- **Netlas Dorks Repo** — github.com/NetlasIO (Featured queries)
- **Nuclei Templates** — github.com/projectdiscovery/nuclei-templates